

Human Skills Development Policy for Higher Education

— Main Policy

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Issued in 2025 by Directorate of Collegiate Education under reference DCE/POL/2025/061, this main policy establishes the arrangements supporting Human Skills Development Policy for Higher Education. In scope are Soft Skills, Leadership, Entrepreneurship, together with related expectations for institutions and stakeholders.

Background and Rationale

The policy landscape has evolved considerably in recent years, and institutions under Directorate of Collegiate Education have responded with renewed attention to Soft Skills, Leadership, Entrepreneurship. This main policy provides the framework needed to guide consistent practice across the sector.

Following sustained engagement with universities, colleges and sector bodies, Directorate of Collegiate Education has prepared this main policy to give effect to Soft Skills, Leadership. It builds on earlier guidance while updating expectations to reflect current conditions.

Purpose

This main policy is intended to translate the objectives of Human Skills Development Policy for Higher Education into actionable direction for institutions, officials and other stakeholders, ensuring that Soft Skills is pursued in a structured and accountable manner.

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Goals

In pursuing these objectives, Directorate of Collegiate Education intends to create conditions in which institutions can deliver consistent, high-quality outcomes in respect of Soft Skills, Leadership, Entrepreneurship, with clear lines of accountability.

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Scope and Applicability

The provisions apply to all universities and colleges under Directorate of Collegiate Education. Sector partners, including employers and professional bodies, are expected to support implementation within their respective spheres.

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Principal Provisions

Key provisions establish minimum standards for Soft Skills, define the responsibilities of institutional leadership, and require documented arrangements for Leadership.

Institutions are required to integrate Soft Skills, Leadership into annual planning cycles, designate accountable officers, and maintain records demonstrating compliance with the expectations set out here.

Implementation Arrangements

Institutions are expected to appoint a lead authority for implementation, adapt the framework to local context, and report progress to Directorate of Collegiate Education in line with the prescribed cycle.

Implementation will proceed through phased institutional adoption, supported by professional development, shared guidance and a common reporting calendar established by Directorate of Collegiate Education.

Roles and Responsibilities

Clear allocation of responsibility is expected at institutional level, with Directorate of Collegiate Education acting as the coordinating authority for evaluation, escalation and cross-institutional learning.

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Monitoring and Evaluation

Progress will be monitored through annual institutional returns, targeted reviews and outcome indicators maintained centrally by Directorate of Collegiate Education. Findings will inform guidance and, where necessary, corrective measures.

Closing Note

Effective implementation of Human Skills Development Policy for Higher Education will depend on sustained institutional commitment and close coordination between Directorate of Collegiate Education and the sector. Institutions are encouraged to embed the arrangements described here into their normal planning and review cycles.